

gautama



Sacred images,
synthetic futures.

SELECTED WORK / 01

Drawing, devotion
and the images we inherit.

gautama.io



INSIDE THE PORTFOLIO

Images in transit.

What survives when an image crosses from one world into another?

Across three bodies of work, gautama follows sacred figures through cultural exchange and the recursive passage between hand and machine. Graphite, gold, spectral color, and digital distortion become ways of asking what we inherit—and what we will choose to worship next.

03	The artist	Bio
04	<i>Bodhisattva</i>	Drawing / devotion
09	<i>Asiatic</i>	An imagined deity
11	<i>Contextual Modernism</i>	An image across cultures
13	Exhibitions & education	CV / contact

ON THE COVER *Bodhisattva*, installation view.
Mixed media and gold leaf on paper.

The artist.

SEATTLE, WASHINGTON



gautama, with his work.

gautama is an
artist based in
Seattle.

Shaped by a family history of immigration and cultural exchange, his drawings trace how culture and religion transform as they move across time and borders — through the membranes between nations, faiths, and eras, and what survives the crossing.

His work asks why humans worship, and how we choose the beings we venerate. How does the culture of the present bind us to the past? And what will it carry into a future increasingly shaped by our machines?

gautama attended classical atelier programs at both the Gage Academy of Art in Seattle, and Vitruvian Art Studio in Chicago. He holds a degree in mathematics and computer science, and has a decade of experience in neuroscience. His work has been exhibited from Seattle to Mexico City to Los Angeles.

Bodhisattva

Drawing from South Asian iconography, *Bodhisattva* imagines the future of human worship.



Bodhisattva. Installation views.



Mixed media and gold leaf on paper
30 × 40 in. / 76.2 × 101.6 cm

HAND → SCAN → PRINT → HAND

An image carried between two worlds.



Bodhisattva. Mixed media and gold leaf on paper. 30 x 40 in.

01 / SELECTED WORK



Bodhisattva. Mixed media and gold leaf on paper. 30 × 40 in.

01 / SELECTED WORK

A CLOSER LOOK

The marks of making.



Bodhisattva.
Details of graphite, gold, and layered color.

Each image begins by hand in graphite, then is scanned, printed, and drawn into again — a cycle repeated until the line between the physical and the digital dissolves. The distortions that accumulate are not errors but relics: evidence of an image carried back and forth between two worlds.

DRAW



SCAN



PRINT



DRAW AGAIN

INHERITANCE & TRANSFORMATION

At the threshold.

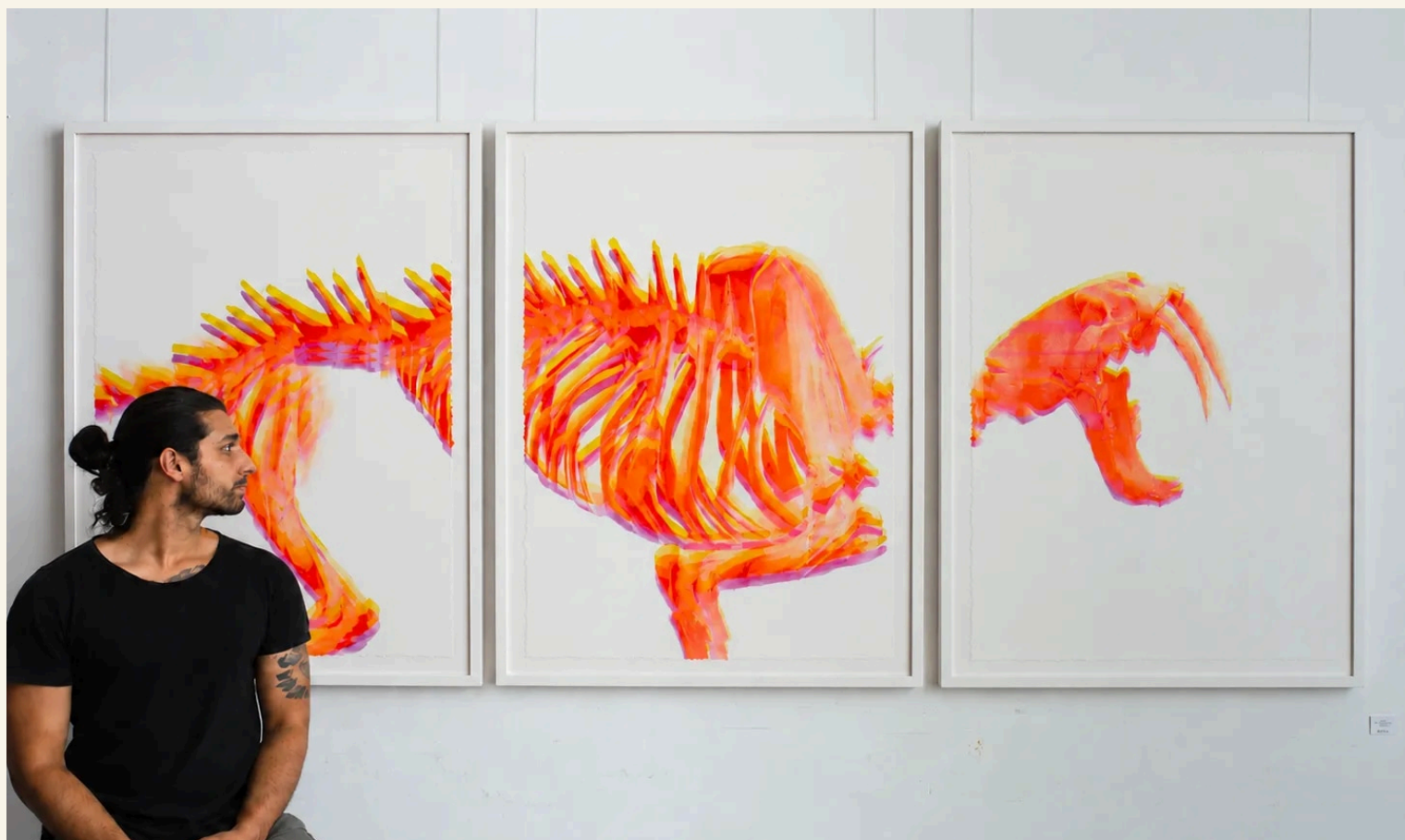


Bodhisattva. Mixed media and gold leaf on paper.
Each 30 × 40 in.



As we grow more intimate with our machines, our devotion may migrate from the natural world toward synthetic ones. These works sit at that threshold, asking what we will choose to venerate next, and how much of our inheritance we will carry across.

Asiatic



Asiatic. Installation view, with the artist.

The shape of a future god.

Asiatic is a composite deity assembled from the skeletons of extinct megafauna — its face the skull of *Smilodon fatalis*, the saber-toothed cat that once hunted alongside, and upon, early humans.

The image is built through the same iterative process that runs through this body of work: drawn by hand, scanned, altered, printed, and drawn again, until the digital and physical leave permanent marks on one another. Those marks remain in the finished drawing as artifacts of its making.

It is a meditation on the beings we choose to worship. Early humans revered the great predators that shaped them; as we now build conscious things inside our machines, I wonder whether these new entities will become our objects of veneration — and whether, like the *Smilodon*, they may one day turn on their makers.

A CLOSER LOOK

Anatomy of a deity.



Asiatic. Skull and saber teeth.



Rib cage and forelimb.

Contextual Modernism

Contextual Modernism takes a familiar figure of Western devotion — the veiled Virgin Mary — and lets it drift into a South Asian frame.

CULTURE IN TRANSLATION

The image is drawn by hand in graphite and charcoal, then digitized, altered, printed, and drawn over again. Each cycle leaves permanent distortions, echoes of the way culture warps as it passes through the digital.

Through those distortions a third eye, an ajna chakra, opens on the Virgin's brow. The gesture inverts a long history: just as South Asian imagery has been absorbed into the Western lexicon, here Western iconography is claimed and remade.

In the internet age, an artifact's origins rarely survive the crossing intact.

FOLLOWING PAGE →

Contextual Modernism. Installation view.



Contextual Modernism. Installation view.

03 / SELECTED WORK

Selected history.

EXHIBITIONS
& EDUCATION

SOLO EXHIBITIONS

2023–2024

Bodhisattva

Art Gallery Studios, Virtual Exhibition

SELECTED GROUP EXHIBITIONS

2024

Pink Tide

Ventura, CA

2024

Clavo Movimiento Feria de Arte

Mexico City, Mexico

2023

Timescape(s)

Moscow Contemporary, Moscow, ID

2023

Works

Axis Gallery, Seattle, WA

2023

Reverence In Uncertainty

Columbia City Gallery, Seattle, WA

2022

Movement/Journey

Columbia City Gallery, Seattle, WA

EDUCATION

2023

Gage Academy of Art, KoH Atelier

2015

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science & Mathematics, University of Illinois

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ARTIST / SEATTLE

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Text and artwork from the artist's website, gautama.io.

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